

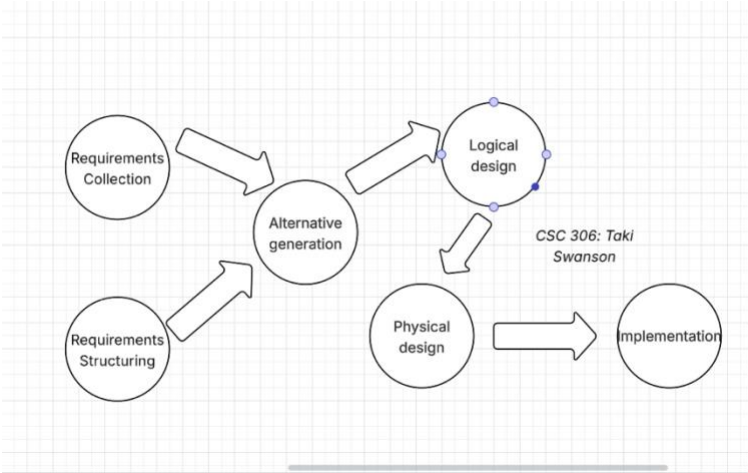
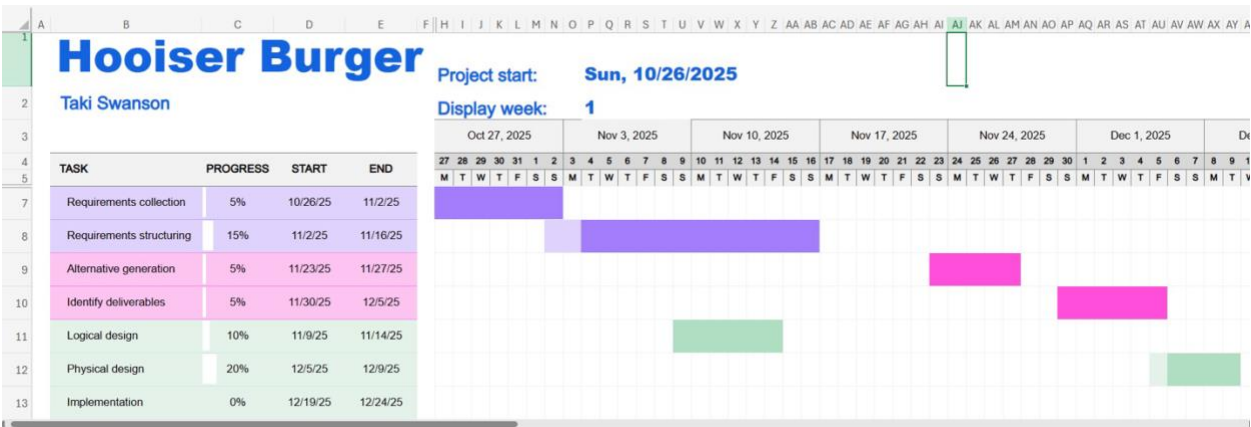
CSC 306: Chapter 3

Hoosier Burger

Project management is all about using the right skills and tools to get projects done successfully. It's more than just organizing tasks; it's about following a structured plan to hit specific goals within a set budget and timeline. Projects are temporary and aim to create something unique.

Key tasks for project managers include figuring out what the project includes, keeping track of deliverables, managing risks, maintaining communication, and planning resources. They need to align their work with the organization's goals and choose methodologies like predictive, adaptive, or a mix of both based on how clear the project is and how its requirements change.

Projects generally go through five main phases: starting up, planning, executing, monitoring and controlling, and closing out. Good project managers are skilled with tools like Microsoft Project and have strong skills in leadership, communication, and problem-solving, especially when it comes to developing with Power Apps.



After reviewing the Hoosier Burger case, the first step is to break down the project into key tasks aimed at improving inventory control, customer ordering, and management reporting systems. The main phases of the project are project initiation, requirements gathering, system design, system development, testing, implementation, and training.

The project initiation phase involves defining objectives, assigning the project team, and obtaining approval from Bob and Thelma. Following this, the requirements gathering phase includes interviewing employees and identifying system needs. The system design phase depends on the completion of the requirements. System development involves coding and setting up the database, followed by system testing to validate functionality. Finally, the implementation and training phase ensures the system runs smoothly.

A network diagram might outline the critical path as follows:

- Project Initiation (2 weeks)
- Requirements Gathering (3 weeks)
- System Design (3 weeks)
- System Development (5 weeks)
- System Testing (2 weeks)
- Implementation & Training (2 weeks)

This timeline totals 17 weeks, and delays in any phase could impact the entire schedule.

"Crashing" the project could shorten the timeline by adding resources or overlapping tasks. For example, starting preliminary design work during the requirements gathering phase could expedite the process. If we were to crash the system development phase by two weeks, it could reduce the total duration to 15 weeks, allowing for a quicker resolution of operational issues.

However, crashing does incur costs. Hiring a contractor at \$60 per hour for 40 hours over two weeks would total approximately \$4,800. If faster delivery leads to increased sales and improved efficiency, this investment could quickly pay off. Hiring a contractor is feasible, as freelance systems analysts and developers are available for \$50 to \$70 per hour. This approach could help meet specific deadlines without overburdening the current team.

In conclusion, crashing the critical path seems strategic if time becomes a concern. The cost of temporary help may be worth it for long-term benefits. However, if Bob and Thelma prefer the 17-week timeline and the budget is tight, it may be best to stick to the original plan. Identifying the critical path keeps the project focused on essential tasks for timely delivery and client satisfaction.

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